

NEW

2026

Ethiopian Health Profession Licensing Examination(EHPLE)

INFORMATION BOOKLET

SURGICAL NURSING



ጤና ሚኒስቴር - ኢትዮጵያ
MINISTRY OF HEALTH - ETHIOPIA

የዜጎች ጤና ለሃገር ብልጽግና!
HEALTHIER CITIZENS FOR PROSPEROUS NATION!



AAU-Testing Center

Message From the State Minister, Ministry of Health -Ethiopia



H.E Mrs. Frehiwot Abebe

Improving healthcare quality is a global priority for sustainable development, with high quality healthcare being a key component of universal health coverage. One strategy to maintain health care standards is through provision of health professionals' competency assessment. Consequently, in 2019, the Ministry of Health-Ethiopia, initiated the Ethiopian Health Profession Licensing Examination (EHPLE) for undergraduates in seven health disciplines, which has since expanded to include 17 health disciplines.

The main goal of this competency assessment is to identify health professionals with minimal competencies necessary to perform their duties safely and competently, thus enhancing the quality of health care services. This initiative is overseen by a dedicated Health and Health Related Institutions and Professionals' Regulatory Lead Executive Office (LEO), comprising four desks, which plays a pivotal role in strengthening the system and enabling the LEO to conduct the competency exam more extensively and with improved organization and quality.

It is important to note that this competency assessment differs significantly from traditional academic or employment examinations. Hence, this information booklet has been created to address the informational needs of both examinees and teaching faculty regarding the EHPLE. Additionally, it aims to facilitate the assessment process, while promoting transparency and ensuring the sustainability of the program.

The preparation of this booklet involved the collaboration of esteemed experts from various higher education institutions, AAU-IER, the Ministry of Health, JHPIEGO-Ethiopia, Amref, Health Professionals 'Associations, and the Ministry of Education. Their invaluable contributions are acknowledged with sincere gratitude, alongside appreciation for the Ministry of Health staff for their unwavering commitment and hard work throughout the project.

Acknowledgements

This Information Booklet for EHPLE is a contribution from several educators, researchers, students and concerned individuals with a genuine interest to propel Ethiopia's medical and health sciences education forward.

The Ministry of Health is grateful for the contribution of many individuals and institutions in realizing this endeavor. Among these are Professional Associations, Student Association, Higher Education Institutions (both public and private), JHPIEGO-Ethiopia, AMREF/HWIP, MoE (Ethernet), UNFPA, AAU-IER and all HHRIPR LEOs staff.



Acronyms and Abbreviations

EHPLE	Ethiopian Health Profession Licensing Examination
ETA	Educational and Training Authority
HEIs	Higher Education Institutions
HHrIPR-LEO	Health and Health-related Institutions and Professionals Regulatory Lead Executive Office
HSTP-II	Health Sector Transformational Plan-II
MCQ	Multiple Choice Question
MOH	Ministry of Health
WHO	World Health Organization

Purpose of the Information Booklet

The EHPLE Information Booklet serves as a comprehensive guide for those individuals seeking information about the exam. It typically outlines basic information for candidate registration, exam development and administration processes and procedures, result notification, and the licensing process. It also includes information on the exam framework, i.e., the exam domain, sub-domain, content, process, and task, with sample exam items specific to each profession.

The publication of this Booklet is crucial for the following reasons:

- **Clarity and guidance:** It provides clear information about the exam by ensuring candidates understand the necessary information to prepare them.
- **Accessibility:** It serves as a readily accessible resource for individuals pursuing to take the exam, consolidating essential information in one document and facilitating easy access to necessary details. It also helps other stakeholders who might be interested in such resources.
- **Transparency:** It promotes transparency in the examination process and fosters trust among stakeholders about the exam.

In summary, the publication of this Booklet is essential for creating a transparent, standardized, and accessible framework that guides candidates through the EHPLE process.

Contents

Message From the State Minister, Ministry of Health -Ethiopia	2
Acknowledgements	3
Acronyms and Abbreviations	4
Purpose of the Information Booklet	5
Definition of terms	7
1. Introduction	1
1.1. Background	1
1.2. The Rationale of EHPLE.....	1
2. Key processes of EHPLE	2
2.1. Registration of candidates.....	2
2.2. Task Analysis	3
2.3. Exam Blueprint.....	3
2.4. Item Development	3
2.5. Item Review	3
2.6. Standard setting method	4
2.7. Exam Administration.....	4
2.8. Scoring and post exam analysis.....	5
2.9. Result notification and appeal management	5
2.10. Licensing.....	5
3. Exam Framework	6
Sample questions	11
Sample Reference.....	22
List of contributors	23
Contact Us.....	23

Definition of terms

- **Domain:** a broad category or area of knowledge or skills of a profession
- **Sub-domain:** a subset of a broader domain that focuses on knowledge or skills related to the overarching domain
- **Content:** a more specific subcategory, which is a breakdown of the sub-domain
- **Task:** the responsibility, knowledge, skill, and attitude of a junior undergraduate professional in an actual work environment
- **Process:** a systematic sequence of steps or actions designed to achieve a specific outcome
- **Learning outcome:** a clear and measurable statement that describes what the examinee is expected to know or be able to do
- **Relative emphasis:** the proportional importance or weight assigned to different content areas or categories within the assessment
- **Item:** a particular multiple-choice question
- **Item developer:** a subject matter expert responsible for writing test items or questions that make up the examination
- **Item reviewer:** a subject matter expert responsible for reviewing and refining the test items or questions that make up the examination
- **Standard setting:** a process of determining a cut-off point or passing score for an exam
- **Item difficulty index:** a statistical measure that indicates the proportion of examinees who answered a particular test item correctly
- **Discrimination index:** a statistical measure that evaluates how well a particular test item differentiates between high-performing and low-performing examinees
- **Admission paper:** a printout paper generated by the system after completing registration that contains the examinee's photo, QR code, and necessary information

1. Introduction

1.1. Background

Competency assessment is one of the strategies for controlling the standard of healthcare services provided in healthcare facilities. The World Health Organization (WHO) recommends all healthcare professionals to have necessary competencies. In Ethiopia, the Health Sector Transformational Plan-II (HSTP-II) states competency assessment of all graduates before joining the health workforce as one of the strategic initiatives.

The Ministry of Health (MOH) launched the Ethiopian Health Profession Licensing Examination (EHPLE) for undergraduates in 2019. The Health and Health-related Institutions and Professionals Regulatory Lead Executive Office (HHrIPR-LEO) of the Ministry of Health is given a mission to implement the Ministry's objective to achieve competency-related goals. It has the responsibility to ensure that the EHPLE meets technical, professional, and legal standards, and to protect the health, safety, and welfare of the public by assessing candidates' abilities to practice competently.

Currently, the exam is given for 17 health professions (Medicine, Nursing, Public Health, Pharmacy, Medical Laboratory Science, Anesthesia, Midwifery, Dental Medicine, Medical Radiology Technology, Environmental Health, Psychiatric Nursing, Pediatric and Child Health Nursing, Emergency and Critical Care Nursing, Human Nutrition, Surgical Nursing, Optometry, and Physiotherapy). Since its introduction until December 2025, a total of 204,811 examinees took the exam in 23 rounds.

1.2. The Rationale of EHPLE

One of the critical functions of the MoH is to guarantee the efficiency, quality, and equity of healthcare delivery and to protect the public from any undesirable consequences in healthcare delivery practices. As professionals' competence is a significant determinant of the quality of health, evaluation of health professionals' competence has now been given due attention. The licensing examination for health professionals serves as a crucial step to ensure that individuals entering the field meet specific competency standards. The sole aim of the competency assessment is to safeguard public health by verifying that health professionals have the minimal basic knowledge, attitude, and skill required to provide safe and effective care.

Licensing exams act as a preventive measure, ensuring that only competent professionals join the health workforce, which, in turn, contributes to reducing the occurrence of medical errors and enhancing overall patient safety. By setting standards through examinations, regulatory bodies strive to minimize the risk of medical errors caused by incompetence.

2. Key processes of EHPLE

EHPLE involves several key processes to ensure the quality and reliability of the examination.

2.1. Registration of candidates

EHPLE has a mandatory online registration system for both new and repeat candidates, which can be found at <http://hple.moh.gov.et>

Please note these important notes during registration.

New Test Takers:



- The list of eligible candidates from governmental and private Higher Education Institutions (HEIs) will be uploaded to MoH's online registration system by the registrar office of their respective HEIs.
- Candidates who completed their education abroad must bring the following documents in person to MoH in order for their names to be uploaded to the online registration system:
 - ✓ Equivalence document from ETA
 - ✓ Externship attachment completion letter after completing the externship assigned by the regulatory body
- Once the name of the candidate is uploaded to the system and registration has opened for the current exam round, the candidate must register at <http://hple.moh.gov.et> by uploading the necessary documents listed below.
 - ✓ a scanned original or temporary degree
 - ✓ a scanned national ID

Repeat Test Takers:



- Since the information about re-exam candidates already exists in the system, the candidate should register by directly going to <http://hple.moh.gov.et>. There is no need for re-exam candidates to upload their documents.

Both new and repeat candidates:



- After completing the registration, the candidate must download and print the admission paper by logging into his/her account using username and password, or national ID FAN.
- The candidate can change the exam center by logging into his/her account only during the registration period
- An application for center change is not allowed after the registration period is closed.

2.2. Task Analysis

The first step of exam development involves conducting a comprehensive task analysis study, which identifies the tasks, knowledge, skills, and abilities required from a junior undergraduate professional in the specific profession. The analysis is typically done through surveys, interviews, or observations of practitioners in the actual work environment, as well as through the Delphi method with subject matter experts.

2.3. Exam Blueprint

Based on the task analysis findings, the exam blueprint is prepared that outlines the content areas to be covered in the examination and the weight or emphasis given to each area. This ensures that the exam reflects the key competencies and knowledge needed for competent practice in that specific profession. Blueprint is the matrix or chart that shows the number and type of test questions represented across the topics in the content area, consistent with the learning outcome and relative weight of the test given to each content area. The blueprint also identifies the percentage weighting of cognitive dimensions as the level of competence tested in each knowledge domain.

Key components of blueprint are:

- Domain
- Sub-domain
- Content
- Task
- Process
- Learning outcome
- Assessment methods
- Assessment tools/instrument (test format)
- Relative emphasis (in percentage)

2.4. Item Development

The items are developed following specific guidelines to ensure clarity, relevance, and fairness. Subject matter experts with experience in the field are selected from HEIs to develop exam questions (items) that align with the exam blueprint. The exam questions focus mainly on “knows how” according to the competency level of the Miller's pyramid. The items are produced in a secure location on designated computers that are free from internet connectivity. The items are scenario-based and constructed with stem, lead-in, and four options/alternatives. All items will have a single-best-answer type of Multiple-Choice Question (MCQ) that addresses the learning outcome defined in each content area. Standard textbooks, updated guidelines, and standards are used as reference materials.

2.5. Item Review

Once developed, the items undergo a rigorous review process by item reviewers. The main purpose of the exam review process is to evaluate content relevance, technical accuracy, clarity, and sensitivity related to culture and religion. More experienced subject matter experts as well as psychometric experts will do the review to ensure the items meet psychometric standards. Subject matter experts shall review the items to confirm that they are accurate, clearly stated, and correctly keyed using the checklist. Psychometric experts shall review the items to ensure that

they are not technically flawed. They also work on editorial review to check grammar, punctuation, and spelling errors. This helps ensure the reliability and validity of the items.

2.6. Standard setting method

The standard setting or cut-off point of the EHPLE is determined using the Modified-Angoff method, which is one of the most widely used and legally defensible standard setting approaches to set a cut-off point for high-stake competency examinations.

The method involves a panel of subject matter experts who evaluate each exam question and then estimate the probability that a minimally competent examinee would answer each test item correctly. The average of the experts' predictions for an exam question becomes its predicted difficulty. The average of the predicted difficulty values across all items on a test is the recommended cut-off point. This point indicates the minimum level of knowledge and skill required to pass.

2.7. Exam Administration

The EHPLE is administered following established protocols and guidelines. Proper exam administration procedures, appropriate security measures, and appropriate consideration for test-takers who need special support will be applied during exam administration at exam centers. The exam is administered in selected HEIs nationally, where candidates can choose based on their convenience at the time of registration. The exam schedule will be posted ahead of time on the MoH website and social media pages. Examinees who have a valid admission paper are eligible to sit for the exam. The mode of exam administration is computer-based testing.

CAUTIONS

- Candidates are allowed



- Attend the orientation session in order to sit for the exam
- Arrive at the exam center on time
- Bring a legal ID and admission paper
- Complete the exam within the allotted time frame

➤ Candidates are **NOT** allowed



- To bring reference materials, blank paper, or notes into the exam center
- To smoke, eat, or drink in the exam room
- To bring mobile phones, tablets, smart watches, camera devices, eyeglasses, calculators or any type of electronic device into the exam center
- To bring their personal belongings to the exam center
- To bring weapons and sharp materials into the exam center
- To give or receive assistance to or from other candidates during the examination

2.8. Scoring and post exam analysis

Once the exam is completed, the scoring process begins. The exam scoring process involves computerized scoring using software.

Post-exam analysis is the process of analyzing examinees' responses to individual test items in order to assess the quality of the items and the exam as a whole. This phase helps to identify any poorly performing items that may need revision or removal from the exam. The item difficulty index, discrimination index, and reliability coefficient are elements of exam analysis.

2.9. Result notification and appeal management

After scoring and analysis, individual score reports are generated and provided to examinees through the website <http://hple.moh.gov.et>. After result notification, examinees can submit their appeal through phone or email within 10 working days after result notification.

2.10. Licensing

The list of examinees who passed the exam will be sent to regional and city administration regulatory bodies. A license is obtained from the regional/zonal health bodies where he/she permanently lives.

Requirements for professional licensing are:



- Passing the EHPLE
- Original or temporary degree
- Educational documents (10th and 12th certificates)
- Medical certificate
- Government issued ID
- Additional prerequisites based on the requirements of regional regulatory bodies

3. Exam Framework

The key broader professional roles, also known as domains or main knowledge areas serve as a building framework for the licensing examination content for Surgical Nursing professionals. The domains are further divided into discrete professional attributes that constitute sub-units (also referred to as sub-domains) defining the professional identity of Surgical Nursing professionals. Tasks specifying the performance level of each sub-domain serve as the final characteristic of the professional duties on which the licensing exam focuses.

The contents of the licensing examination are presented below, structured into key roles (domains), sub-units (sub-domains), and tasks. The examination emphasis for each domain and sub-domain, out of the total 100% questions, is indicated in brackets.

Key professional roles/ domains

- ☐ Patient Care (77%)
- ☐ Scholar (5.5%)
- ☐ Professionalism (7.0%)
- ☐ Leadership and management (5.0%)
- ☐ Health promotion and disease prevention (5.5%)

Key role/ domain 1: Patient Care (77%)

Description: This domain encompasses the professional role of surgical nursing in the provision of high-quality, safe, and patient-centered surgical nursing care for diverse groups of patients. The provision of up-to-date, ethical, and resource-efficient surgical nursing care requires the application of integrated knowledge of biomedical, clinical, social, and behavioral sciences within their scope of practice. As patient care providers, surgical nursing professionals shall implement the surgical nursing care process by collecting and interpreting information, making clinical decisions, carrying out diagnostic and therapeutic nursing interventions, providing nursing care, and evaluating interventions. To demonstrate competence in this domain, candidates shall apply such integrated knowledge in the following sub-areas:

- ☐ Perioperative Nursing (6.5%)
- ☐ Surgical Nursing (66.5%)
- ☐ Surgical Nursing for special population (4.0%)

Key role/ domain 2: Scholar (5.5%)

Description: This domain encompasses the professional roles of surgical nursing in generating and utilizing scientific data to improve the health and well-being of the community and broaden their scientific knowledge within the healthcare system and community setting. Providing this service requires the application of integrated knowledge in research methods,

measurements of health and disease, biostatistics, epidemiology, clinical audit, evidence-based practice, and research ethics. To demonstrate competence in this domain, candidates must possess applied knowledge in planning, problem identification, data collection, analysis, interpretation, report writing, and dissemination of research findings.

Key role/ domain 3: Professionalism (7.0%)

Description: This domain encompasses the professional commitment of surgical nursing to promoting the health and well-being of individuals and society through adhering to ethical standards, maintaining personal integrity, and upholding high standards of competence in all areas of practice. To exhibit competence in this domain, candidates must possess applied knowledge of ethical principles, medico-legal practices, effective communication, accountability to the profession and society, maintenance of professional excellence and personal health, continuous professional development and professional values such as, integrity, honesty, altruism, and humility, motivated, compassionate, and respectful care.

Key role/ domain 4: Leadership and management (5.0%)

Description: This domain encompasses the professional roles of surgical nursing in envisioning a high-quality healthcare system through self-awareness, active participation in healthcare team development and leadership, and managing health systems. Providing this service requires the application of integrated knowledge in continuous quality improvement, effective health system leadership, management, and healthcare ethics. To demonstrate competence in this domain candidate shall possess applied knowledge to plan, organize, staff, lead, execute, monitor, and control healthcare resources and activities.

Key role/ domain 5: Health promotion and disease prevention (5.5%)

Description: This domain encompasses the professional roles of surgical nursing in enhancing the health and well-being of patients, communities, and the larger populations they serve through health advocacy, disease prevention, health promotion, health protection, and the promotion of health equity. Providing this service takes an integrated understanding of determinants of health, health informatics, epidemiology, communicable disease control, and health education.

Table 1 Exam Content for Surgical Nursing

Domain 1: Patient Care	
Sub-domain 1.1: Perioperative Nursing	
Content	Tasks
Preoperative (Surgical instrument, patient preparation)	Assess patients preoperatively
	Formulate different Nursing diagnosis preoperatively
	Develop preoperative individual Nursing care plan
	Provide common preoperative Nursing intervention
	Appraise preoperative Nursing intervention
Intraoperative (Antiseptic solution, surgical attire and sterile technique, patient safety, surgical hand scrub, gowning and gloving, role of OR team)	Apply patient safety measures
Postoperative (Post-anaesthesia care, Instrument processing)	Examine the patient conditions in post anesthetic care unit(PACU)
	Formulate different Nursing diagnosis for patient conditions in PACU
	Develop comprehensive individual Nursing care plan for patient conditions in PACU
	Provide Nursing intervention for patient conditions in PACU
	Evaluate the Nursing intervention for patient conditions in PACU
Sub-domain 1.2: Surgical Nursing	
Content	Task
Surgical disorders of EENT(Cataract, Trauma of Eye, Glaucoma, Ear Abscess, Foreign bodies in the ear , Perforation of the tympanic membrane, Mastoiditis , Epistaxis, Fracture of the Nose, Nasal polyps, Peritonsillar abscess, Ear irrigation, eye irrigation,)	Assess patients with common surgical respiratory disorders
	Formulate different Nursing diagnosis for patients with surgical respiratory disorders
	Formulate medical diagnosis for patients with surgical respiratory disorders(Pneumothorax,Haemothorax, Haemo-Pneumothorax)
	Develop comprehensive individual Nursing care plan for patients with surgical respiratory disorders
	Provide Nursing intervention for patients with surgical respiratory disorders
Surgical disorders of Respiratory system(Chest drainage, Thoracentesis, Postural drainage, Tracheostomy care, Airway suctioning, Oxygen administration, Lung abscess, Pleural effusion, Atelectasis, chest trauma , pulmonary embolism)	Assess patients with common surgical respiratory disorders
	Formulate different Nursing diagnosis for patients with surgical respiratory disorders
	Formulate medical diagnosis for patients with surgical respiratory disorders(Pneumothorax,Haemothorax, Haemo-Pneumothorax)
	Develop comprehensive individual Nursing care plan for patients with surgical respiratory disorders
	Provide Nursing intervention for patients with surgical respiratory disorders
Surgical disorders of cardiovascular system (Cardiac trauma, myocardial rupture, varicose vein , Coronary artery disease, DVT,Cardiac arrest,CPR, Aneurism, blood transfusion ,medication and fluid administration)	Evaluate the Nursing intervention for patients with surgical respiratory disorders
	Assess patients with common surgical cardiovascular disorders
	Formulate different Nursing diagnosis for patients with surgical cardiovascular disorders
	Develop comprehensive individual Nursing care plan for patients with surgical cardiovascular disorders
	Provide Nursing intervention for patients with surgical cardiovascular disorders
Surgical disorders of GI system (Periodontal abscess, Achalasia, Gastric outlet obstruction, Intestinal obstruction, Peritonitis, Appendicitis, Gastro duodenal perforation, Gastric cancer, Colorectal cancer, Hernias, Rectocele, Haemorrhoids , Anal fissure and fistula, Pancreatitis, Cholelithiasis, Abdominal	Evaluate the Nursing intervention for patients with surgical cardiovascular disorders
	Assess patients with common surgical gastrointestinal disorders
	Formulate different Nursing diagnosis for patients with surgical gastrointestinal disorders
	Formulate medical diagnosis for patients with surgical gastrointestinal disorders (appendicitis, intestinal obstruction, cholelithiasis, peritonitis, Hernia, perforated PUD)
	Develop comprehensive individual Nursing care plan for patients

Trauma, NG (insertion, Feeding, Lavage), Abdominal Paracentesis , inflammatory bowel disease , colostomy care ,enema)	with surgical gastrointestinal disorders
	Provide Nursing intervention for patients with surgical gastrointestinal disorders
	Evaluate the Nursing intervention for patients with surgical gastrointestinal disorders
Surgical disorders of GUT system (Urolithiasis and nephrolithiasis, Hydrocele, Testicular torsion , BPH, catheterization (insertion ,Bladder irrigation), Urethral stricture, Testicular cancer, Sitz bath)	Assess patients with common surgical GUT disorders
	Formulate different Nursing diagnosis for patients with surgical GUT disorders
	Develop comprehensive individual Nursing care plan for patients with surgical GUT disorders
	Provide Nursing intervention for patients with surgical GUT disorders
	Evaluate the Nursing intervention for patients with surgical GUT disorders
Surgical disorders of Endocrine system (Breast disorders,Thyroid gland Disorder, Parathyroid gland Disorder, Diabetic Foot ulcer, Adrenal gland Disorder, pituitary gland disorder)	Assess patients with common surgical endocrine disorders including breast disorders
	Formulate different Nursing diagnosis for patients with surgical endocrine including breast disorders
	Formulate medical diagnosis for patients with surgical endocrine disorders (Goiter)
	Develop comprehensive individual Nursing care plan for patients with surgical endocrine including breast disorders
	Provide Nursing intervention for patients with surgical endocrine including breast disorders
	Evaluate the Nursing intervention for patients with surgical endocrine disorders including breast disorders
Surgical disorders of integumentary system (Burn, wound care, Cellulites, Papilloma, lipoma, adenoma, Viral warts, Plastic surgery, Suturing, abcess drainage)	Assess patients with common surgical integumentary disorders
	Formulate different Nursing diagnosis for patients with surgical integumentary disorders
	Develop comprehensive individual Nursing care plan for patients with surgical integumentary disorders
	Provide Nursing intervention for patients with surgical integumentary disorders
	Evaluate the Nursing intervention for patients with surgical integumentary disorders
Surgical disorders of nervous system (Increased ICP, Head injury, Brain abscess, Spinal cord injury, pain management)	Assess patients with common surgical neurologic disorders
	Formulate different Nursing diagnosis for patients with surgical neurologic disorders
	Formulate medical diagnosis for patients with surgical neurologic disorders (head injury, spinal cord injury)
	Develop comprehensive individual Nursing care plan for patients with surgical neurologic disorders
	Provide Nursing intervention for patients with surgical neurologic disorders
	Evaluate the Nursing intervention for patients with surgical neurologic disorders
Surgical disorders of Musculo skeletal system (Musculo skeletal trauma (Soft tissue injury, Fracture), Joint and connective tissue disease (Rheumatoid arthritis, Gouty arthritis, Osteoporosis,Osteomyelitis, Osteoarthritis, Septic arthritis), Amputation), splinting, cast removal, skin traction	Assess patients with common surgical musculoskeletal disorders
	Formulate different Nursing diagnosis for patients with surgical musculoskeletal disorders
	Formulate medical diagnosis for patients with surgical musculoskeletal disorders (fracture, osteomyelitis, arthritis)
	Develop comprehensive individual Nursing care plan for patients with surgical musculoskeletal disorders
	Provide Nursing intervention for patients with surgical musculoskeletal disorders
	Evaluate the Nursing intervention for patients with surgical musculoskeletal disorders
Sub-domain 1.3: Surgical Nursing for special population	
Content	Task
Pediatrics(Painless scrotal swelling in children and adolescent, Phimosis and paraphimosis,	Assess common paediatrics surgical disorders
	Formulate different Nursing diagnosis for paediatrics surgical

Club feet, cleft lip and cleft palate, congenital heart defect, circumcision)	disorders
	Develop comprehensive individual Nursing care plan for paediatrics surgical disorders
	Provide Nursing intervention for paediatric surgical disorders
	Evaluate Nursing intervention for patients with surgical paediatrics disorders
Mental health (Anxiety, depression, posttraumatic disorder related to disease process and surgical procedure)	Assess and formulate nursing diagnosis for patients with common mental illness
	Develop comprehensive individual Nursing care plan for patients with common mental illness
	Provide Nursing intervention and evaluate patients with common mental illness
Domain 2: Health Promotion & Disease Prevention	
Sub-domain 2.1 Nutrition	
Content	Tasks
Malnutrition (Macronutrient, Micronutrient deficiencies)	Assess nutritional status
	Diagnose nutritional status
	Manage nutritional status
Sub-domain 2.2 Health Education	
Content	Task
Basic principles of health education, application of health education theories and models in behavior change	Provide health education
Sub-domain 2.3 Environmental health	
Content	Task
Waste management	Implement waste management system
Sub-domain 2.4 CDC	
Content	Task
General prevention methods of communicable diseases, Principles of communicable disease control, Chain of disease transmission	Apply communicable diseases prevention and control mechanisms
Domain 3: Leadership and Management	
Content	Tasks
Management functions (Planning, organizing, leading (directing and motivating), staffing, controlling), Time resource management, Group dynamics and teamwork, Nursing care delivery models, Conflict management	Apply the management function for health care system
Domain 4: Scholar	
Content	Tasks
Measuring disease frequency (incidence, prevalence), study design, sampling techniques, measures of central tendency, Instructional objectives, Methods of teaching	Develop research proposal and report
	Apply common teaching method
Domain 5: Professionalism	
Content	Tasks
Ethical principles, Code of Ethics, Ethical theories, the concept of crimes and torts	Adhere to ethical principles pertaining to nursing practice
	Adhere to legal issues in Nursing

Sample questions

1. A 35-year-old patient, who has a history of digoxin therapy, is scheduled to undergo abdominal surgery. The nurse responsible for preparing the patient for surgery got the results of preoperative investigations ready. The serum potassium level is 3.2mmol/L. (NR: 3.5mmol/L – 4.5mmol/L).

What is the most appropriate immediate action regarding this result?

- A. Administer potassium supplement
- B. Inform the surgical team about the result
- C. Encourage dietary intake of potassium
- D. Proceed with the surgery, as it does not matter

Answer key: The Answer is **B**

Explanation: The patient's potassium level is 3.2 mmol/L, which is below the normal range (3.5–4.5 mmol/L). In a patient taking digoxin, hypokalemia increases the risk of digoxin **toxicity**, which may result in arrhythmias. Therefore, the most appropriate immediate action is to inform the surgical team to evaluate the risk and take corrective steps before proceeding with surgery.

2. A male patient was confused when the physician told him that his health condition was not good. Besides, the physician left the patient by telling him that he may benefit only from surgical intervention. The patient does not know about his problem, is still confused and full of fear, and does not know what procedure will be done. But he decided to undergo surgery.

What nursing intervention is most appropriate for this patient in this case?

- A. Tell the patient not to fear for anything
- B. Provide preoperative patient teaching
- C. Facilitate family time for the patient
- D. Encourage him to tell you his concerns

Answer key: The Answer is **B**

Explanation: The patient is confused and lacks knowledge about his condition and the upcoming surgery. The most appropriate nursing intervention is to provide preoperative teaching to ensure the patient understands the procedure, reduces fear, and is able to give informed consent. This helps in improving cooperation and outcomes.

3. A nursing student practicing at a surgical ward has frequent contact with patients due to the higher number of cases. He plans to practice hand hygiene more frequently, but he has dryness and skin irritation problem. The nursing instructor advised the student to perform techniques that cause less dryness and skin irritation.

What is the most likely recommended technique in this case?

- A. Alcohol-based hand rub
- B. Soap with water
- C. Ash with water
- D. Hydrogen peroxide

Answer key: The Answer is **A**

Explanation: The student experiences dryness and irritation from frequent hand washing. Among hand hygiene methods, alcohol-based hand rub is the preferred method in clinical settings as it is effective against microbes, faster to use, and less irritating to the skin compared to soap and water.

4. A fourth-year nursing student who is assigned to operating room (OR) told to remove mask¹⁰⁸ or respirator after leaving the patient's room and close the door. The student asks the scrub nurse about the purpose of removing respirator after leaving the patient's room. What is the most likely response of the scrub nurse in this case?
- A. It helps for proper disposal of the mask or respirator
 - B. It helps in preventing mask or respirator from contamination
 - C. It helps in keeping the privacy of the patient
 - D. It helps in preventing contact with airborne disease

Answer key: The Answer is **D**

Explanation: Airborne precautions are essential when caring for patients with airborne infections like tuberculosis or measles. Removing a respirator or mask after exiting the room helps prevent exposure to airborne pathogens and reduces the risk of contamination, protecting healthcare workers.

5. A nurse was discussing a discharge plan with a patient who was operated for benign prostatic hyperplasia. After the discussion, the nurse assessed some components to check his readiness for discharge. What finding most likely changes the decision to discharge the patient?
- A. Orientation to place, events, and time
 - B. Urine output less than 30mL/h
 - C. Nausea and vomiting under control
 - D. Minimal pain

Answer key: The Answer is **B**

Explanation: A urine output less than 30 mL/hour is a sign of oliguria, indicating possible renal impairment or post-surgical complication. This finding suggests the patient is not yet stable for discharge and requires further observation and intervention.

6. A 33-year-old male patient presented to a clinic with a history of eye discomfort. His eye has been tearing for three hours, and he cannot open his eye due to the pain. On physical examination, the foreign body has stuck to the eye surface. What is the most likely examination technique used in this case?
- A. Percussion
 - B. Palpation
 - C. Inspection
 - D. Auscultation

Answer key: The Answer is **C**

Explanation: In a patient with a foreign body in the eye, the primary and most effective method of assessment is inspection. Visual examination allows healthcare providers to directly observe the foreign object and assess for signs of irritation, redness, and tearing.

7. A 30-year-old man complains of severe nasal bleeding an hour after admission to the hospital. The nurse observed that the patient had a subconjunctival haemorrhage and gingival bleeding. What is the most likely cause of nasal bleeding in this case?
- A. Systemic cause
 - B. Local cause
 - C. Nasal sniffers
 - D. Nasal dryness

Answer key: The Answer is **A**

Explanation: The patient has multiple sites of bleeding (nose, eyes, gums), which strongly suggests a systemic cause, such as a coagulation disorder, platelet dysfunction, or a systemic illness affecting blood vessels. Local nasal causes would not explain conjunctival or gingival bleeding.

8. A 62-year-old man presented with a history of blunt trauma, a blow from a fist. He has bruising around the orbit and maxillary area, and limitation of upward gaze. What is the most likely priority nursing diagnosis in this case?
- A. Risk for bleeding
 - B. Risk for corneal injury
 - C. Risk for dry eye
 - D. Risk for shock

Answer key: The Answer is **B**

Explanation: After trauma to the eye, limited upward gaze and bruising indicate possible orbital fracture with entrapment of extraocular muscles, posing a risk for corneal injury due to improper eye closure or exposure. Immediate attention is needed to prevent vision damage.

9. A nurse is preparing a 36-year-old adult patient who is to undergo mastoidectomy. While counselling the patient, the nurse stressed the importance of visiting the health center when he feels sick and keeping follow-up appointments to avoid complications. What is the most likely outcome that indicates good understanding of the patient in this case?
- A. Remains free of discomfort or pain
 - B. Demonstrates no signs or symptoms of infection
 - C. Remains free of injury and trauma
 - D. Exhibit the importance of scheduling

Answer key: The Answer is **D**

Explanation: When a nurse emphasizes follow-up and early reporting of symptoms, the patient's ability to schedule and attend follow-up visits shows understanding and adherence to discharge education. This outcome reflects effective health teaching and planning for complication prevention.

10. A 45-year-old male patient with a diagnosis of obstructed bronchus is admitted to the surgical ward due to acute exacerbation of wheezing, cough, and decreased oxygen saturation. The nurse suspected the diagnosis of chronic obstructive pulmonary disease (COPD) and wanted to confirm it by percussion of the patient's chest.

What percussion note would support the nurse's diagnosis?

- A. Dull
- B. Resonant
- C. Hyper-resonant
- D. Flat

Answer key: The Answer is C

Explanation: In COPD, lungs become hyperinflated due to air trapping, resulting in hyper-resonant percussion sounds. This finding helps in confirming the chronic obstructive changes in the lung structure that are typical in patients with long-standing respiratory illness.

11. A 55-year-old patient came to the hospital with a history of an untreated chronic productive cough and moderate amounts of foul-smelling sputum. On assessment, the patient has an accumulation of thick and purulent fluid within the pleural space.

What is the most likely cause of the patient's problem in this case?

- A. Hematogenous infection
- B. Bacterial infection
- C. Iatrogenic causes
- D. Lung abscess

Answer key: The Answer is D

Explanation: A lung abscess can lead to accumulation of foul-smelling purulent sputum, and if it ruptures, it can cause empyema in the pleural space. This condition often follows untreated pneumonia or chronic infection, matching the patient's clinical history.

12. A surgical ward head nurse was a person-oriented supervisor. The head nurse controls the workers based on needs. The head nurse has done nursing rotation past few weeks. At that time, the head nurse assigned the workers considering their training and working style. The head nurse's concern during supervision was the worker's personality.

What is the most likely characteristic that shows the head nurse is a person-oriented supervisor?

- A. Concerns of workers' personality
- B. Seeking quantity and quality of the task
- C. Controlling the workers based on their needs
- D. Assignments of the workers considering their training

Answer key: The Answer is A

Explanation: A person-oriented supervisor focuses on personal traits, emotions, and individual needs of the team members. The head nurse's concern about the personality of the staff demonstrates person-centered leadership that supports effective team performance.

13. A researcher has planned to conduct a study to assess the knowledge and attitudes of first-year university students of a public university in Ethiopia regarding human immunodeficiency virus (HIV). The researcher decided to collect data at the time of their first arrival at the University. As a result, the researcher selected and recruited every other student who arrived at the university during the study period.

What is the most likely sampling technique employed in this scenario?

- A. Cluster sampling
- B. Stratified Sampling
- C. Systematic sampling
- D. Simple random sampling

Answer key: The Answer is C

Explanation: Selecting every other student who arrives is a form of systematic sampling, where participants are chosen at regular intervals from an ordered population list. This method ensures even distribution and is easy to implement.

14. A nurse in a hospital usually commits maltreatment of children if they are not cooperating with the treatment. The head nurse heard a rumor on this and developed a strict regulation regarding child abuse and made it every health care provider's obligation to report suspected child abuse to protect children.

What is the most likely ethical principle the head nurse is trying to correct in this case?

- A. Nonmaleficence
- B. Beneficence
- C. Autonomy
- D. Justice

Answer key: The Answer is A

Explanation: The principle of nonmaleficence requires healthcare providers to avoid causing harm. In this case, the head nurse's action to prevent child maltreatment and enforce reporting rules addresses the ethical obligation to protect vulnerable populations from harm.

15. A nurse working in a health center is providing public health education on environmental hygiene at selected Kebele in the catchment area. During the health education, the nurse used objective displays of information, including photographs and posters.

What is the most appropriate health communication method used in the above case?

- A. Visual Communication
- B. Verbal Communication
- C. Written Communication
- D. Non-Verbal Communication

Answer key: The Answer is A

Explanation: Using photographs and posters during health education involves visual communication. This method is effective in enhancing understanding, especially in community health settings, where literacy levels may vary and visual aids can reinforce the message.

Sample Reference

- Brunner and suddarth's text book, 12th edition, 2010, Page No, 296
- Jane C. Rothrock, Alexander's Care of the patient in surgery, 16th ed., 2018, page 859-
- Lewis's Medical Surgical Nursing, 12th ed, 2023, page 338
- Medical surgical nursing; concepts for inter-professional collaborative care 10th ed., page # 3148
- Fundamental of nursing 10th edition Taylor, Lillis, Lynn page:59
- Textbook of Medical surgical nursing 15th ed., Page: 4583
- Schwart's 11th edition p272
- Principles of management, Cliffsquick review by Ellen A Benowitz, page 5.
- Biostatistics: a foundation for analysis in the health sciences. 10th edition, 2013. Page 10-11
- Legal, Ethical, and Political Issues in Nursing, Second Edition, page: 109
- National CRC Training Participant Manual, February 2017, page: 95

List of contributors

Mr. Endalkachew Tsedal	MoH/ HHRIPR LEO
Dr. Meron Yakob	MoH/ HHRIPR Exam Development and Administration Desk Lead
Ermias G/Yohannes	MoH/ HHRIPR
Dr. Wudasio Teshome	MoH/ HHRIPR
Dr. Melese Achamo	MoH/ HHRIPR
Tsedale Tafesse	MoH/ HHRIPR
Mekonnen Desie	MoH/ HHRIPR
Abera Bezabih	MoH/ HHRIPR
Fikadie Dagnaw	MoH/ HHRIPR
Melkamu Gereme	MoH/ HHRIPR
Tadele Asefa	MoH/ HHRIPR
Mebrat Tadesse	MoH/ HHRIPR
Neway H/Michael	MoH/ HHRIPR
Mebrahtu Tarekegn	MoH/ HHRIPR
Milkoman Ayele	MoH/ HHRIPR
Bethlehem Shikabew	MoH/ HHRIPR
Amanuel Tesfay	MoH/ HHRIPR

Contact Us

Ministry of Health – Ethiopia

Street Address: - 1234 Sudan Street, Addis Ababa – Ethiopia

Telephone: +251-118275936

Hotline service: - 952

Website: <https://www.moh.gov.et>

EHPLE Information Booklet 2026